

Define Problem Statements

Phase 1: Brainstorming and Ideation Phase

shopEZ E-commerce Marketplace | MERN Stack | June 2026

1. Define Problem Statements

The following structured problem statements were derived from interviews, observational research, and competitive analysis of existing e-commerce platforms.

2. Persona A: The Convenience-Seeking Shopper (End-User)

Field	Details
Profile	A busy professional, age 28, who frequently shops online for electronics, clothing, and home goods.
Objective	Quick, friction-free purchasing. Finding products matching price/rating thresholds. Secure tokenized checkouts.

Current Behavior	Uses Amazon and ASOS. Abandons checkouts if more than 3 shipping forms appear or no coupon inputs are visible.
Pain Points	• Cart items disappearing on browser session expiry. • Slow-loading image assets causing frustration. • Login sessions expiring too quickly, wiping active shopping carts. • Hidden shipping fees revealed only at payment stage.
Gains Expected	• Immediate autocomplete suggestions on keyword searches. • Instant checkout totals with exact breakdown (price, coupon discount, shipping, taxes). • Persistent, cross-session shopping cart retention. • Trustable verified buyer review badges.

3. Persona B: The Operations and Control Manager (Admin/Seller)

Field	Details
Profile	A retail entrepreneur, age 35, running a direct-to-consumer brand.
Objective	Real-time visibility into inventory stocks, order status updates, and overall sales trends.
Current Behavior	Uses Shopify or spreadsheets. Manually checks stock, updates product listings via CMS admin forms.

Pain Points	• Clunky dashboard portals requiring multiple steps to add items. • Slow inventory updates leading to oversells. • No central overview linking sales, inventory, and customer management. • No automated low-stock alert system.
Gains Expected	• Single-dashboard overview with sales graphs, low-stock alarms, and customer tables. • Direct image upload integration (Multer) for product photos. • Instant coupon code management (create, toggle, delete). • One-click order delivery milestone progression.

4. Problem Statement Summary

Core Problem: shopEZ addresses the fundamental gap between the increasing demand for seamless, transparent, and feature-rich e-commerce experiences and the inability of SMBs to implement such platforms affordably and quickly. The platform simultaneously bridges administrative inefficiency by unifying inventory, order, customer, and analytics management into a single modern interface.